

HOOK TEMPLATE BANK

**50 LINKEDIN
HOOKS TO
USE IN YOUR
POSTS ASAP!**

*Free plug & play templates,
examples & why they work!*



SHOAIB AHMED | BUILT 195+ PERSONAL BRANDS ON LINKEDIN



Hello friends,

Staring at a blinking cursor again?

Wondering how everyone else is posting daily like it's nothing, while you're stuck second-guessing every line? You want to show up. You want to be consistent. You want to make ££ using LinkedIn.

But when it's time to post...

Brain fog.

I've written 18,750+ LinkedIn posts for 195+ Founders, CEOs, Freelancers, Coaches and Creators across 40 categories on HUNDREDS of topics, themes and subject areas.

Over the next 28 pages, you'll get:

- 50 (including 10 NEW) proven hooks that stop the scroll
- Plug-and-play post prompts that make posting feel EASY
- Explanation of why these hooks work (so you can learn!)



The good news?

You don't need *more* time, *more* confidence, or *more* motivation.

You need better prompts.

No "just add value" advice with no actual value. But tried-and-tested, plug-and-play hook templates I use (for me and my clients). This guide will do the heavy lifting *for* you.

You've got this. I've got you.

Handwritten signature of Shoaib Ahmed in orange ink.

1.

TEMPLATE HOOK:

I used to [belief or mistake].
Until I learned [lesson].

EXAMPLE HOOK:

I thought cold emailing didn't work.
Until I signed \$12,000 in 9 days 😊

WHY IT WORKS:

This breaks down the belief barrier while teasing transformation. The personal experience and tangible result add credibility and drive curiosity, making readers eager to replicate success.

2.

TEMPLATE HOOK:

The biggest lie in [industry]?
[Myth to later debunk].

EXAMPLE HOOK:

The biggest lie in SaaS marketing?
Paid ads deliver the highest ROI 🚀

WHY IT WORKS:

It directly challenges industry norms, triggering curiosity and authority. The bold statement encourages readers to rethink their assumptions, positioning you as a subject matter expert.

3.

TEMPLATE HOOK:

**I thought [personal misconception]
But [mistake to avoid]**

EXAMPLE HOOK:

**I thought I'd hit £10K by month 1.
But this sales call error STOPPED me!**

WHY IT WORKS:

It shows vulnerability, making the story feel authentic. Teasing the error grabs attention and leverages readers' fear of making the same mistake.

4.

TEMPLATE HOOK:

**Most people: [stereotypical advice]
Me: [Less common advice]**

EXAMPLE HOOK:

**Most people: "LinkedIn hooks are important"
Me: Curiosity gaps are 10x more important 🧐🧐**

WHY IT WORKS:

It promises deeper insight beyond common advice, leading readers to believe they're about to discover something novel. It taps into the human desire to access exclusive knowledge.

5.

TEMPLATE HOOK:

**Here's how I helped [person] get [result].
Without [X]. Without [Y]. Just this ↓**

EXAMPLE HOOK:

**My client (SaaS Founder) signed 5 clients in 2 days.
No cold DMs. No cold emails. Just this ↓**

WHY IT WORKS:

Showing results via a real example offers instant proof. The “no x” part (using things people find cumbersome) creates intrigue, making the audience wonder how they can replicate this.

6.

TEMPLATE HOOK:

**[Challenge 1] [Challenge 2] [Challenge 3]
Here's how [desirable transformation].**

EXAMPLE HOOK:

**Low following? No engagement? No proof?
Here's how I'd STILL sign a client. (In ONLY 24 hours!)**

WHY IT WORKS:

The questions make the post relatable to people in that position, which makes your target audience feel seen. The second line promises a highly desirable transformation, creating curiosity for the solution. The use of '24 hours' reduces friction (so it's doable for anyone).

7.

TEMPLATE HOOK:

**Most people do [thing].
Here's [better approach]**

EXAMPLE HOOK:

**Most lead-gen coaches post daily.
I post once, then distribute it 5 ways.**

WHY IT WORKS:

This uses contrast to challenge conventional wisdom. It taps into the psychology of efficiency, offering a smarter, less time-consuming alternative to a widespread habit.

8.

TEMPLATE HOOK:

**This [action] [result] [timeframe]
But I NEARLY [risk]**

EXAMPLE HOOK:

**This subject line 4x my email opens in 3 days.
But I NEARLY didn't use it!**

WHY IT WORKS:

The promise of a quick, easy-to-action fix (in this case, higher open rates) hooks readers who want immediate results. Speaking from personal experience adds credibility to the advice.

9.

TEMPLATE HOOK:

My client [achievement] [timeframe]
[debunk common myth]

EXAMPLE HOOK:

My client lost 6kg of pure body fat in 28 days.
And NO! He didn't use weight loss pills 🚩

WHY IT WORKS:

This approach teases a desirable outcome and positions the achievement as attainable for others. Importantly, it reduces reader objection/fear of the process by eliminating a common approach. This creates more curiosity - the outcome is more impressive.

10.

TEMPLATE HOOK:

If you're [identity] struggling with [problem]
The next [X lines] will [positive outcome].

EXAMPLE HOOK:

If you're ADHD and struggle to time-manage...
The next 9 lines will TRANSFORM your life 🖐️

WHY IT WORKS:

It speaks directly to a specific audience, so they feel seen. There is a sense of urgency to read more (9 lines is low effort compared to the big reward/payoff, i.e. life transformation).

11.

TEMPLATE HOOK:

**You don't need [thing].
You need [real need].**

EXAMPLE HOOK:

**You don't need more website traffic.
You need better conversion strategies 📈**

WHY IT WORKS:

It identifies a misconception and quickly flips it, providing an immediate reframe. The reader realises they've been focusing on the wrong thing, positioning you as a trusted advisor.

12.

TEMPLATE HOOK:

**People think [common thing] helps [desirable goal]
But [alternative action] is 10x better.**

EXAMPLE HOOK:

**People think testimonials boost conversions.
But BEFORE vs AFTER results convert 10x more!**

WHY IT WORKS:

This immediately challenges common wisdom, encouraging the reader to rethink their strategies. The more nuanced angle piques curiosity and builds thought leadership.

13.

TEMPLATE HOOK:

I did [simple action]
It [desirable stat-based result].

EXAMPLE HOOK:

I changed one line in my LinkedIn headline.
It increased profile traffic by 63%.

WHY IT WORKS:

The promise of a simple action that leads to significant results encourages readers to engage because they, too, would like a low-friction way to generate better outcomes. The specificity of the stat and the use of anecdotal data boost trust and believability.

14.

TEMPLATE HOOK:

I used to [old action]
Now [better results from a new action]

EXAMPLE HOOK:

I used to think sending cold DMs was useless.
Now, it's how I sign 77% of my clients! 🚀

WHY IT WORKS:

The shift appeals to the reader's desire for transformation. It positions you as someone who has already solved a common problem, creating instant relatability. The result creates curiosity about the process to achieve it. The number adds proof (positions you as someone to trust).

Don't PANIC! 🚨

More HOOKS are coming your way...

And these hook prompts are *great to grab attention*.

But they are not enough.

You need to *sustain attention* by:

- Following through with tangible value across the entire post.
- Creating a compelling story/narrative from hook to final line.
- Using viral copywriting principles (to keep people engaged).

And then?

Your wider strategy and execution (LinkedIn profile, posting themes, engagement methods, outreach process, DM tactics, lead magnets and social selling funnel) must be optimised.

So you can move your reader *from*:

ATTENTION → ENGAGEMENT → ACTION → CONVERSION

And MAKE MO-NEH! 💰

I've watched THOUSANDS OF PEOPLE FAIL because they rely on guesswork, deploy outdated strategies and repeat tired techniques that don't work for LinkedIn today!!!

So, I wanna help you.

How?

With 1:1 “No Bullshit” LinkedIn coaching. In 60 minutes, I'll diagnose EVERYTHING you're doing wrong and give you a personalised masterclass to TRANSFORM your LinkedIn success.

INTERESTED? Want more details?

[Fill out this form.](#)

15.

TEMPLATE HOOK:

Doing [thing], but not seeing [result].
You need to try [suggest action]

EXAMPLE HOOK:

Posting daily, but not generating leads?
You need to try the RISE method! 

WHY IT WORKS:

This hook taps into frustration and offers a solution. Framing a method with a unique name or acronym creates novelty (this heightens the urgency to read and instils a FOMO effect).

16.

TEMPLATE HOOK:

This ONE [action] delivered [result]
[reduce friction]

EXAMPLE HOOK:

This ONE writing hack doubled my inbound leads.
(You don't need to be a trained copywriter!)

WHY IT WORKS:

It builds anticipation by promising a simple, transformative solution. The second line makes the solution more accessible, low-friction and sound simple enough for anyone to benefit from.

17.

TEMPLATE HOOK:

How I [dream outcome] - and how you can too
[Rhetorical question]

EXAMPLE HOOK:

How I've gained 4 hours a week - thanks to ONE tool.
Want more free time in your diary? 🌂

WHY IT WORKS:

This highlights a compelling (and accessible) result through a personal case study. The question teases an explanation of 'how' to achieve the result, keeping readers gripped.

18.

TEMPLATE HOOK:

Don't [common action]
You only need [alternative action]

EXAMPLE HOOK:

Don't waste months on an 11-page website.
You only need ONE clean landing page.

WHY IT WORKS:

This hook makes a strong statement against a common thing people chase and suggests an alternative. It creates curiosity as to 'why' and the confidence of the messaging positions the writer as someone who helps others avoid costly mistakes, increasing trust.

19.

TEMPLATE HOOK:

**If you want [desirable result], do one thing.
[suggestion action] not [common action]. Here's how:**

EXAMPLE HOOK:

**If you want more sales, do one thing:
Sell offers, not products. (Here's the trick):**

WHY IT WORKS:

This is direct and results-oriented. It clearly states the desired outcome and provides an interesting and novel way of doing it (with little explanation) - so it amps up curiosity.

20.

TEMPLATE HOOK:

**What's the secret to [desirable outcome]
This is what DID vs DIDN'T work for me!**

EXAMPLE HOOK:

**What's the secret to hitting 50k followers?
This is what DID vs DIDN'T work for me!**

WHY IT WORKS:

This hook promises insider knowledge, which appeals to readers looking for deeper insights. It provokes FOMO (fear of missing out on winning) and FOFU (fear of fucking up - and failing).

21.

TEMPLATE HOOK:

[% growth]: How [brand or person] achieved it
This is [positive teasing of process]

EXAMPLE HOOK:

110% YoY Growth: How Nike Achieved It
This is their INSANE marketing hack!

WHY IT WORKS:

This sets up a clear promise: the reader knows they're about to learn a replicable strategy used by a market leader. Consider all the key elements: data-driven (110% YoY), story-led (Nike's success), emotionally charged ("INSANE"), actionable ("marketing hack")

22.

TEMPLATE HOOK:

I stopped [common strategy]. Got [result] anyway.
Here's the [new strategy] that did it.

EXAMPLE HOOK:

I stopped posting on LinkedIn. Got 3 clients anyway.
Here's the DM template that did it.

WHY IT WORKS:

This builds intrigue by hinting at a secret or unique insight (a contrarian take). It positions you as an expert with an exclusive method that promises higher success rates.

23.

TEMPLATE HOOK:

No [X]. No [Y]. Still [aspirational result].
Here's the [X step] breakdown.

EXAMPLE HOOK:

No pitch. No agent. Still landed TEDx.
Here's my exact 5-step speaker strategy!

WHY IT WORKS:

By offering a clear, step-by-step approach, this hook promises value. It positions you as a trusted mentor (based on the personal case study) who can help others replicate success.

24.

TEMPLATE HOOK:

Forget [traditional method].
Here's how I [result] through [new method]

EXAMPLE HOOK:

Forget wasting hours writing LinkedIn posts!
Here's how I signed a £33k deal from a single DM.

WHY IT WORKS:

It challenges the status quo by offering an easier, less stressful alternative. The promise of a simpler method resonates with anyone overwhelmed by conventional strategies.

25.

TEMPLATE HOOK:

[Career success]. [Personal failure]
Here's what I wish I had done differently:

EXAMPLE HOOK:

Millionaire by 37. Divorced by 38.
Here's what I wish I had done differently:

WHY IT WORKS:

Offers a high-contrast punch in just a few words - success followed by loss - sparking instant curiosity about the emotional cost of achievement (a universally relatable human story).

26.

TEMPLATE HOOK:

Don't try [common approach] if you want [desirable goal].
I'd do this instead:

EXAMPLE HOOK:

Don't hire a team if you want to scale quickly.
I'd do this instead:

WHY IT WORKS:

This hook uses reverse psychology to challenge conventional thinking. It suggests the opposite of what people expect, making them want to learn why the counterintuitive approach works.

27.

TEMPLATE HOOK:

Everyone saw the [launch/win/success].
No one saw the [struggle behind it].

EXAMPLE HOOK:

Everyone saw me win this award on stage.
No one saw the panic attack 4 minutes before.

WHY IT WORKS:

The hook works by creating emotional contrast between external success and internal struggle, making it highly relatable. The personal vulnerability sets up a scene for a story.

28.

TEMPLATE HOOK:

Stop doing [common mistake].
Do [action]. Let me explain...

EXAMPLE HOOK:

Stop focusing on building your product.
Build your audience first. Let me explain...

WHY IT WORKS:

It goes against the typical advice that most entrepreneurs hear and creates an open loop, encouraging readers to keep reading to find out what the “better” strategy is.

29.

TEMPLATE HOOK:

I've never shared this [tool/strategy],
But [specific result] in [timeframe]

EXAMPLE HOOK:

I've never shared this lead-gen hack.
But it boosted my pipeline by 40% in 3 days 🔥

WHY IT WORKS:

It creates exclusivity and curiosity by teasing a resource. The “never shared before” element grips attention. The time-framed stat shows proof - positions the writer as a trusted authority.

30.

TEMPLATE HOOK:

I was stuck in [negative state] for [time].
Until I [story-led action]:

EXAMPLE HOOK:

I was stuck in burnout cycles for 7 years.
Until I had this conversation with my boss:

WHY IT WORKS:

The personal struggle and transformation resonate with readers facing similar challenges. The second line teases a single solution, but in a way that promises a specific story for the reader.

31.

TEMPLATE HOOK:

How I went from [negative], [negative] [negative]
To [positive] [positive] [positive]. In ONLY [time]

EXAMPLE HOOK:

How I went from fat, broke and miserable.
To be healthy, happy and rich - In ONLY 90 days!

WHY IT WORKS:

This hook taps into a strong before-and-after transformation - the use of extreme contrasts (fat vs. healthy, broke vs. rich) creates intrigue for readers to learn how they can do it too.

32.

TEMPLATE HOOK:

2024: [negative state]
2025: [positive state]

EXAMPLE HOOK:

2024: Made redundant whilst 6 months pregnant.
2025: Run my own 6-figure business from home!

WHY IT WORKS:

The journey from struggle to success offers a positive emotional payoff that invokes hope - it creates an underdog story scenario, which empowers and inspires readers in tough situations.

33.

TEMPLATE HOOK:

1st [action]: [negative outcome]
[later action]: [positive outcome]

EXAMPLE HOOK:

1st product launch: 0 sales 😞
7th product launch: 1,048 sales 📈

WHY IT WORKS:

Contrasts 0 sales with 1,048 sales, creating immediate curiosity as to how to achieve that desirable end goal. It uses real numbers to make the journey tangible, offers a relatable struggle (starting from zero) and teases an explanation of 'how' others can win too.

34.

TEMPLATE HOOK:

I found a way to [result] in [time saving]
It all came down to [action]

EXAMPLE HOOK:

I found a way to close deals in 73% less time.
It all came down to my automation trick! 🤖

WHY IT WORKS:

It implies a shortcut to success - taps into the desire for efficiency. "Trick" makes it sound exclusive (creating curiosity for what it involves) and the number adds proof/believability.

35.

TEMPLATE HOOK:

Here's how I [achieved X] overnight.
I switched to [insert action].

EXAMPLE HOOK:

Here's how I got 6 new leads overnight.
I switched to an irresistible content strategy.

WHY IT WORKS:

This creates a sense of urgency and excitement around a quick win. The promise of an "overnight" success grabs attention, especially for those looking for rapid solutions.

36.

TEMPLATE HOOK:

Learn how to [action] in [low time]
This is the ONLY guide you need:

EXAMPLE HOOK:

Learn how to create a LinkedIn banner in 17 minutes.
This is the ONLY guide you need 💪

WHY IT WORKS:

It promises fast results, high value, and ease—the trifecta for scroll-stopping content. In 17 minutes sets a clear, quick time frame - promises a quick win. The second line heightens the perceived value of this post.

37.

TEMPLATE HOOK:

What you think matters: [common tactic]
What actually matters: [alternative tactic]

EXAMPLE HOOK:

What you think matters: creating content
What actually matters: **DISTRIBUTING** content

WHY IT WORKS:

This hook uses a reversal to challenge conventional thinking. It captures attention by presenting an alternative truth that gets the audience thinking about how they can apply it to their own work. The contrast teases an explanation of 'why', so it promises to educate.

38.

TEMPLATE HOOK:

I [ambitious action] in [timeframe]
[negative outcome]

EXAMPLE HOOK:

I asked for a promotion 3 months into my job.
My boss laughed and said 'no'.

WHY IT WORKS:

Combines bold action, emotional tension and relatability - sets up a universally relatable failure story (everyone can read this regardless of position, age, industry). The level of personal vulnerability is rare to see on LinkedIn, making it stand out.

39.

TEMPLATE HOOK:

I [action that goes against the norm]
Here's why [action] is best:

EXAMPLE HOOK:

I said "no" and REJECTED 4 keen investors!
Here's why bootstrapping is best:

WHY IT WORKS:

The hook presents an unconventional approach / subverts common expectations. This resonates with startups, solopreneurs, and bootstrapped founders who are questioning VC culture or debating funding vs. independence.

40.

TEMPLATE HOOK:

"You need to [common advice]"
I disagree! Here's why that's a BAD idea:

EXAMPLE HOOK:

"You need to work for free to get your first client."
I disagree! Here's why that's a BAD idea:

WHY IT WORKS:

This combines controversy, tension and strong opinion. It takes a common way of thinking or advice that lots of people have heard and debunks it. The strong second line creates curiosity as to why the feeling is so intense. It speaks to a topic a lot of people have opinions on.

41.

TEMPLATE HOOK:

After [time period], I nervously [vulnerable/scary action].

EXAMPLE HOOK:

After seven months of maternity leave, I nervously asked for a meeting with my boss.

WHY IT WORKS:

It opens mid-story with vulnerability and tension. Readers instinctively want to know how it went. It's personable, emotive and sets up a visual scene anchored in time.

42.

TEMPLATE HOOK:

**Here's the savage truth about [aspiration / persona]:
→ [uncomfortable reality / statement].**

EXAMPLE HOOK:

**Savage truth for wannabe hustle bros:
→ You won't manifest your way to £1M.**

WHY IT WORKS:

Direct, confrontational language polarises and hooks readers who are tired of fluffy advice. Presents an alternative, contrarian view which sets up a bit of drama and signals disagreement (which is a way to grip attention). Also teases an alternative worldview further in the post.

43.

TEMPLATE HOOK:

Most people [expected behaviour] at [age / stage].
But [contrasting example]

EXAMPLE HOOK:

Most people slow down in their 60s.
But not Christopher, my dad.

WHY IT WORKS:

This hook exploits contrast and curiosity. The first line activates a widely held assumption; the second line disrupts it with a personal exception. Readers instinctively want to know why this person is different and what lesson can be learned, making it emotionally sticky.

44.

TEMPLATE HOOK:

[Time period] ago, I [small, seemingly random action].

EXAMPLE HOOK:

11 years ago, I sent a random DM to a guy who ran a Facebook meme page.

WHY IT WORKS:

It sets up a story anchored in time and doesn't give away what the outcome was. It creates intrigue for what happened next. The smaller and more random the action, the more people lean in with questions and curiosity i.e. why is this person sharing this on LinkedIn?

45.

TEMPLATE HOOK:

Ask any [identity]: “Do you want [undesirable thing]?”
They’ll say no.

EXAMPLE HOOK:

Ask any hard-working person: “Do you want to be micromanaged?”
They’ll say no.

WHY IT WORKS:

This hook creates instant agreement. By starting with a rhetorical question that has an obvious answer, it aligns the reader with the author emotionally. Once agreement is established, readers are far more open to the argument or solution that follows. It frames the author as on the same side as the reader and both united against a common enemy.

46.

TEMPLATE HOOK:

Nobody warned me about [specific consequence or experience].

EXAMPLE HOOK:

Nobody warned me that posting on LinkedIn would lead to getting trolled by 200+ strangers in a public Reddit thread.

WHY IT WORKS:

It leverages omission bias - what people don't tell you feels more valuable than common advice. It also signals emotional depth, promising a post rooted in lived experience rather than surface-level tips. The more shocking the consequence you include, the better.

47.

TEMPLATE HOOK:

WHAT A [time period]!!!
[specific, impressive outcome].

EXAMPLE HOOK:

WHAT A WEEK!!!
3 of my clients just upgraded their contracts.

WHY IT WORKS:

This hook uses emotional amplification (caps + exclamation) to signal something big just happened. It creates momentum and social proof without sounding salesy, making readers curious about what led to the result. It's classic 'building in public' + trust scaffolding (but framed as a celebration/announcement - so it doesn't feel like you're selling).

48.

TEMPLATE HOOK:

Everyone keeps asking me: "[specific how-question]?"

EXAMPLE HOOK:

Everyone keeps asking me: "How did you get 200+ people to sign up to your webinar in just 7 days?"

WHY IT WORKS:

It positions the author as someone others are already learning from, while naturally setting up an explanation the reader wants too. You can insert a specific how question from your target audience, essentially answering what's on their mind and highlighting your proof / expertise.

49.

TEMPLATE HOOK:

In [time period], I almost said:
“[emotionally loaded statement]”

EXAMPLE HOOK:

In Feb last year, I came the closest I’ve ever been to saying: “I’m going to close my business”

WHY IT WORKS:

This hook opens at a moment of emotional brinkmanship. The quoted thought feels intimate and human, pulling the reader into a turning-point story. It can be used to shock the reader (tip: include a statement your audience wouldn’t expect you to think).

50.

TEMPLATE HOOK:

[Time period] ago, my life looked like this:
[Bleak or uncertain moment].

EXAMPLE HOOK:

3 years ago, my life looked like this:
Wake up → do 9-5pm I hated → sleep → repeat

WHY IT WORKS:

This hook is visual and sets up a clear before → after arc that primes them for transformation. The more bleak/ uncertain your choices are, the more people are intrigued to see what happened. Tip: mirror what your audience feels - so they get curious about how you solved it.
